# The Jewel of Praise for Glorious Śabarapāda

Śrīśabarapādastotra · Toh 1176 · Derge Tengyur
དཔལ་ར་ཁྲོད་ཞབས་ཀྱི་བསྟོད་པ་རིན་པོ་ཆེ།

The Jewel of Praise for Glorious Śabarapāda, in Sanskrit Śrīśabarapādastotra and in Tibetan Dpal ri khrod zhabs kyi bstod pa rin po che, is a tantric hymn in verse honoring Śabara, the great Indian mahāsiddha who lived as a hunter-yogin in the mountains. It opens by explaining his name syllable by syllable and then praises him as a guru and lord of yogins, taking each part of his attire in turn, the bow and arrow, bone ornaments, ash, peacock feathers and a garland of half-red, half-black berries, as a symbol of the path: the bow of wisdom joined with the string of skillful means, the arrow of selflessness, and the union of conventional and ultimate truth. It closes by dedicating its merit so that all beings may be drawn out of the ocean of existence, and according to its colophon it was composed by the great scholar Vanaratna and translated at Dingri, in the author's own presence, by Zhönu Pal. It is Toh 1176 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the section of praises (stotra).

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In the language of India: śrī śabarapāda stotnaṃ
In the language of Tibet: The Jewel of Praise for Glorious Śabarapāda

I pay homage at the feet of the glorious holy guru.

Vajrasattva, of the supreme nature of vajra,
Of the essence of space, by nature supreme in all aspects,
Dispels desire; therefore he is expressed by the syllable śa.
I bow to the lord of yogins, glorious Śabara.

Though ever arisen and ever present, in the vajra-like play
That is praised by way of its cause, he rests in meditative equipoise;
Therefore he is truly expressed by the syllable ba.
Homage to the protector Śabara, lord of ascetics.

Ever delighting in the great secret of the Victors, the supreme beings,
And bringing others to delight in the Dharma:
Such a one is expressed by the syllable ra.
To that yogin renowned as Śabara I pay homage.

Having bowed deeply to Śabara, explained by these three syllables,
Who could praise an ocean of qualities?
Yet, guru, through the power of my faith in you,

I long to praise you, and so I shall offer praise.

Taking up in direct perception the bow of wisdom,
With its bowstring of skillful means, utterly hard and unbreakable,
You drew the arrow of innate selflessness,
Experienced in direct perception by yourself;
And when, to purify completely the misdeeds
Gathered since beginningless time by all who are counted among beings,
You struck the target, the obscurations of afflictions and of the knowable and the rest,
It was pierced: O steadfast one, how wondrous you are!

Sealed by selflessness itself, the limit of reality
Encircles the edge of your brow and makes it beautiful.
How wonderful! You who thirst for the nectar of others' welfare,
Are you not the lord of heroes, who has no foe?

Desire, hatred toward others, and delusion:
These three are renowned in the world as poisons.
Because you dispel every one of them without remainder,
You have uprooted the foe and bound on the hero's silken streamer.

Whoever, free of attachment to desires, has become humble in speech,
Released from the grand and lofty words of hardened pride,
The fine earrings of the vajra of pure speech
Hang upon his two ears: to him I pay homage.

The vajra garlands of human bone, the very embodiment of compassion,
Are the supreme jewel necklace about his neck;
To that guru, lord of yogins, who surely makes beings flourish,
Whose nature is space, I pay homage.

Because you are free of taking life, upon your hands
The glorious bracelets of the Tathāgatas are surely bound;
The six pure perfections, generosity and the rest,
Are the six garlands of guñjā berries surely bound upon you.

Because even impure desire and forceful means touch
The very purity that is clearly evident, the cord of your hair
Is wound and bound at the very hub of the wheel of the two:
Saṃsāra and nirvāṇa are utterly pure.

To utterly pacify the plight of people tormented by fear,
And the angry demeanor of humans that harms themselves,
Anklets ring the bases of your lotus feet,
And for that very reason, it is held, a pair of armlets is wound upon you.

With the ashes of the unchanging mind you have thoroughly covered your body,
So that every pore is completely filled;
Therefore your body is like a mirror.
Glorious guru with a vajra body, I bow to you.

To purify as well desire and the rest,
Which cling with delight to the body of the aggregates,
You have smeared your body thoroughly with ashes:
Glorious one, in you I take refuge.

The two long locks of matted hair are the couple, husband and wife,
And their clear and lively swaying shows this;
The long locks abiding in the wheel of great bliss
Are this union, blessed by luminosity.

Just as, when the lion sends forth its terrifying roar,
The great elephant is frightened and tormented with fear,
So are you, protector, to the obstructors,
With the call of your horn, whose nature is indestructible sound.

The ornament of your garland of guñjā berries is wondrous:
Its red half is conventional truth,
And its black half is the nature of the ultimate.
Their oneness, to which I bow, is most auspicious.

To expand the bliss whose nature is innate
Is the uncontrived reality of all the Tathāgatas;
Therefore the peacock tail, brilliant upon your body, proclaims it:
A great wonder!

To honor the qualities of mastery, you carry and wear
Those equal in number to these thirty-two channels;
The seed of peace and bliss lies at your own heart:
Glorious Śabara, to you I always pay homage.

Supreme treasure of the excellence of perfect awakening,
Though you possess the vajras of the sublime body,

From that, solely to accomplish the welfare of sentient beings,
You have surely taken up all manner of activities as well.

With the syllable kha, oh, you cut the hosts of Māra to pieces;
Then, with the syllable ga, fully knowing the mind, you went into the sky.
You dispel delusion and the rest; therefore, by kha and ga,
You are the body of space, and the sky-goer too.

You destroyed the tenets of the wicked non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), whom all revered,
And you set human beings in the state of a sugata.
To those well gathered you taught the sublime Dharma, bringing benefit,
The ground for journeying with ease on the sublime path to lasting bliss.

You hold the vase that fulfills every wish,
Brimming with hundreds of miracles and magical displays.
How wonderful! The Victor who has amassed excellence for the welfare of others
Is this holy Śabara: I bow at your feet.

Thus, whatever virtue has been gained here, in this Jewel of Praise
To the holy guru, the lord Śabara, composed by the holy ascetic Vanaratna,
By it may those sunk in the ocean of existence be drawn out,
And may all swiftly attain the ground of spontaneous bliss and abundance.

This completes The Jewel of Praise for Glorious Śabarapāda. It was composed by the great scholar Śrī Vanaratna, and translated at Dingri by the Dharma teacher Zhönu Pal in the presence of that very holy master.

## Translator's Notes

• The opening verses explain the name Śabara syllable by syllable (śa, ba, ra), and a later verse treats kha and ga as a play on "sky-goer" (Sanskrit khaga), each syllable being glossed by the deed it stands for. The ornaments described (bow and arrow, bone garlands, peacock feathers, a garland of guñjā berries, and ash) are the traditional attire of Śabara, the mountain-dwelling yogin, and each is given a symbolic meaning; guñjā berries are half red and half black, which the hymn takes as the two truths, and □□□□ is read as this berry on that basis. The second verse (on the syllable ba) and the verse on the cord of hair wound at the hub of the wheel are obscure in the Tibetan, and their renderings are tentative. In the verse on the thirty-two channels the thing worn is not named; it is probably the peacock feathers of the verse before. The author named in the dedication and colophon is the Bengali paṇḍita Vanaratna, and the translator Zhönu Pal is Gö Lotsāwa.

## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.